

Rip Van Winkle

Washington Irving · 1819

First published: The Sketch Book, 1819

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Sketchbook_of_Geoffrey_Crayon_(1819)/Rip_Van_Winkle (revision 15556862), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Rip Van Winkle suggest about change and time?
- What does Rip Van Winkle suggest about the American Revolution?
- What does Rip Van Winkle suggest about escape from responsibility?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Rip Van Winkle	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*change and time* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Rip Van Winkle

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Washington Irving's life or times connects to change and time in “Rip Van Winkle”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (change and time, the American Revolution, escape from responsibility).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Washington Irving was born in New York City on 3 April 1783, the youngest of eleven children of a merchant family, and named after George Washington. He won fame with a comic History of New York (1809) by "Diedrich Knickerbocker" and lived in England from 1815, where he published The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (1819–20), containing "Rip Van Winkle" and "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow." He was among the first American writers admired in Europe; he later served as U.S. minister to Spain and died at Sunnyside, his home in Tarrytown, New York, on 28 November 1859.

Historical and cultural context

Set in a Dutch village in New York's Catskill Mountains before and after the American Revolution. Irving wrote it in England in 1818–19, drawing on German folk tales (one about a goatherd named Peter Klaus). Rip sleeps through the Revolution and wakes to a republic.

Publication and reception, then and now

Published in The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent., first American part, 1819, under Irving's pseudonym.

Then: A transatlantic success; The Sketch Book made Irving the first American writer with an international reputation.

Now: A foundational American story; "Rip Van Winkle" has become a byword for someone out of touch with change.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Rip, a good-natured, idle villager henpecked by his wife, wanders into the mountains, drinks with a strange company of old Dutchmen playing ninepins, and falls asleep.

Main themes

- change and continuity.
- escape from responsibility.
- American identity.

Why it matters

It asks what changes in a revolution and what stays the same.

Spoilers · teacher only

He wakes twenty years later; his wife is dead, the Revolution has happened, and King George's picture on the inn sign has become George Washington's. He settles in as a village storyteller.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open Rip Van Winkle: If you slept for twenty years, what would surprise you most?
Prompt: Before we open Rip Van Winkle: If you slept for twenty years, what would surprise you most?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
folk tale; frame narrator; satire; setting.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. Washington Irving was born in New York City on 3 April 1783, the youngest of eleven children of a merchant family, and named after George Washington. He won fame with a comic History of New York (1809) by "Diedrich Knickerbocker" and lived in England from 1815, where he published The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent. (1819–20), containing "Rip Van Winkle" and "The Legend of Sleepy Hollow." He was among the first American writers admired in Europe; he later served as U.S. minister to Spain and died at Sunnyside, his home in Tarrytown, New York, on 28 November 1859. The world of the book. Set in a Dutch village in New York's Catskill Mountains before and after the American Revolution. Irving wrote it in England in 1818–19, drawing on German folk tales (one about a goatherd named Peter Klaus). Rip sleeps through the Revolution and wakes to a republic. Publication and reception. Published in The Sketch Book of Geoffrey Crayon, Gent., first American part, 1819, under Irving's pseudonym. Then: A transatlantic success; The Sketch Book made Irving the first American writer with an international reputation. Now: A foundational American story; "Rip Van Winkle" has become a byword for someone out of touch with change.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night" slowly and put it in my own words: To Rip, the whole twenty years felt like a single night. Next, craft. I notice the comparison between huge and tiny spans of time. The strongest word is "night": the small word shrinks two decades to one sleep. Then, effect. What does Rip's sense of time tell us? My answer: While the country changed from colony to republic, Rip stood still; Irving uses that gap to show how big historical change can feel unreal.

> *the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night" slowly and put it in my own words: To Rip, the whole twenty years felt like a single night. Next, craft. I notice the comparison between huge and tiny spans of time. The strongest word is "night": the small word shrinks two decades to one sleep. Then, effect. What does Rip's sense of time tell us? My answer: While the country changed from colony to republic, Rip stood still; Irving uses that gap to show how big historical change can feel unreal.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Rip, a good-natured, idle villager henpecked by his wife, wanders into the mountains, drinks with a strange company of old Dutchmen playing ninepins, and falls asleep. Themes to track: change and continuity.: escape from responsibility.: American identity.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: change and time. Prediction: easygoing Rip, who escapes his chores in the Kaatskill Mountains, will miss something important while he is away. Question: what will he find has changed in his village?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Rip Van Winkle: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: change and time. Prediction: easygoing Rip, who escapes his chores in the Kaatskill Mountains, will miss something important while he is away. Question: what will he find has changed in his village?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Rip Van Winkle still matter? It asks what changes in a revolution and what stays the same.
Anchor question: Why might Rip Van Winkle still be taught today?
Facilitation: It asks what changes in a revolution and what stays the same.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Irving published this story in 1819, about forty years after the Revolution, while living in England. Why might he write about a man who sleeps through the Revolution? Answer: Accept answers such as: to show how fast America had changed; to create an American legend from Dutch folk tales; living abroad made him look back at his country with humor.
Exit ticket: Irving published this story in 1819, about forty years after the Revolution, while living in England. Why might he write about a man who sleeps through the Revolution?
Answer: Accept answers such as: to show how fast America had changed; to create an American legend from Dutch folk tales; living abroad made him look back at his country with humor.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Rip Van Winkle.

Teacher notes · sources: Historic Hudson Valley, "Washington Irving" (https://hudsonvalley.org/); Britannica, "Washington Irving" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Washington-Irving); Washington Irving, The Sketch Book (1819–20) (https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/2048)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- Content note: the portrayal of Dame Van Winkle uses period stereotypes of the nagging wife; discuss critically.

Lesson 2: Rip Van Winkle

Focus: waking into a changed nation

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "Rip Van Winkle" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1, L.9-10.4

Content note (mild drinking (alcohol), a scolding wife played for comedy, a passing mention of possible suicide, a period ethnic slur for an indigenous woman): Sensitive content: Mild drinking (alcohol); a scolding wife played for comedy; a passing mention of possible suicide; a period ethnic slur for an Indigenous woman. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. The text quotes racial slurs in period dialogue: decide in advance that no one reads them aloud, and name why the author records them.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes mild drinking (alcohol); a scolding wife played for comedy; a passing mention of possible suicide; a period ethnic slur for an Indigenous woman. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this story is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Good-natured, idle Rip Van Winkle wanders into the Catskill Mountains to escape his scolding wife, meets strange men in old Dutch dress playing ninepins, drinks their liquor, and falls asleep. He wakes twenty years later, bearded and stiff. In the village, King George's portrait has become George Washington, his wife is dead, and the Revolution has happened. He settles into old age telling his story.

Background: Published in 1819 in The Sketch Book under the persona 'Geoffrey Crayon' and the fictional historian Diedrich Knickerbocker; Irving adapted a German folktale.

Significance: One of the first American short stories to become a national myth.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
If you fell asleep for twenty years, what would surprise you most when you woke? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to change and continuity because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes mild drinking (alcohol); a scolding wife played for comedy; a passing mention of possible suicide; a period ethnic slur for an Indigenous woman. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: If you fell asleep for twenty years, what would surprise you most when you woke?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to change and continuity because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: dismembered — separated, detached (from the main range); conciliating — friendly and trying to win good will; vexations — annoyances; worries; revisit — visit again; counterpart — something very like another; a copy. "dismembered": Origin of "dismember": Old French desmembrer. "conciliating": Origin of "conciliate": Latin conciliātus. "revisit": Origin: Middle French revisiter; earlier Latin revīsitāre. "counterpart": Origin: an English formation from counter- + part.
Words: dismembered: separated, detached (from the main range) · conciliating: friendly and trying to win good will · vexations: annoyances; worries · revisit: visit again · counterpart: something very like another; a copy

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1819 in The Sketch Book under the persona 'Geoffrey Crayon' and the fictional historian Diedrich Knickerbocker; Irving adapted a German folktale. One of the first American short stories to become a national myth. FrameNarrator: Diedrich Knickerbocker supposedly found the story; this layered frame makes truth uncertain. Satire: The village politics after the Revolution are as noisy and empty as before. Setting: The Catskills are magical; the village is ordinary. Watch for the sign: political change that is only surface.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "petticoat government" slowly and put it in my own words: Rip, back from his long sleep, rejoices that his wife is dead and he is no longer ruled at home. Next, craft. I notice the joking mix of words: "government," a political term, applied to a marriage. The strongest word is "petticoat": a petticoat is a woman's underskirt, so the phrase mocks rule by a wife. Then, effect. Why is Rip glad to be free from "petticoat government"? My answer: Rip is glad to be free from "petticoat government" because his wife has died; he slept through a revolution, but the only tyranny he cares about escaping was hers, a joke showing he has not changed.

> *petticoat government (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "petticoat government" slowly and put it in my own words: Rip, back from his long sleep, rejoices that his wife is dead and he is no longer ruled at home. Next, craft. I notice the joking mix of words: "government," a political term, applied to a marriage. The strongest word is "petticoat": a petticoat is a woman's underskirt, so the phrase mocks rule by a wife. Then, effect. Why is Rip glad to be free from "petticoat government"? My answer: Rip is glad to be free from "petticoat government" because his wife has died; he slept through a revolution, but the only tyranny he cares about escaping was hers, a joke showing he has not changed.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Identity crisis. Look at the craft: The village politics after the Revolution are as noisy and empty as before. Ask: How does this line connect to change and continuity? Expected: The inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. (Identity crisis.)

> *I'm not myself--I'm somebody else (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Identity crisis. Look at the craft: The village politics after the Revolution are as noisy and empty as before.
Ask: How does this line connect to change and continuity?
Expected answer: The inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. (Identity crisis.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for framenarrator, satire (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about waking into a changed nation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Rip Van Winkle develops the idea of waking into a changed nation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. When the text says "petticoat government" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74), it shows this directly. Rip, still free of "petticoat government," wonders "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else," yet he soon settles back exactly as before.
Task: Annotate the story for framenarrator, satire (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about waking into a changed nation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Rip Van Winkle develops the idea of waking into a changed nation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. When the text says "petticoat government" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74), it shows this directly. Rip, still free of "petticoat government," wonders "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else," yet he soon settles back exactly as before.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: If you fell asleep for twenty years, what would surprise you most when you woke? Ask: is Rip a hero or a slacker?
Anchor question: If you fell asleep for twenty years, what would surprise you most when you woke?
Facilitation: Ask: is Rip a hero or a slacker?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about waking into a changed nation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. ("petticoat government", Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about waking into a changed nation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. ("petticoat government", Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how framenarrator shapes waking into a changed nation. Key takeaway: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **FrameNarrator:** Diedrich Knickerbocker supposedly found the story; this layered frame makes truth uncertain.
- **Satire:** The village politics after the Revolution are as noisy and empty as before.
- **Setting:** The Catskills are magical; the village is ordinary.

Themes and how they develop

- **change and continuity:** the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sign:** political change that is only surface.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74) Rip's escape.
- “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59) Identity crisis.
- “the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70) The sleep.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people.
Evidence: “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74)
Reasoning: Rip, still free of "petticoat government," wonders "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else," yet he soon settles back exactly as before.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
dismembered (adjective)	separated, detached (from the main range)	*They are a dismembered branch of the great Appalachian family, and are seen away to the west of the river, swelling up to a noble height, and lording it over the surrounding country.*	“dismembered”: Origin of “dismember”: Old French desmembrer. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/dismember#Etymology)
conciliating (adjective)	friendly and trying to win good will	*Indeed, to the latter circumstance might be owing that meekness of spirit which gained him such universal popularity; for those men are apt to be obsequious and conciliating abroad,*	“conciliating”: Origin of “conciliate”: Latin conciliātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/conciliate#Etymology)

		who are under the discipline of shrews at home.	
vexations (noun)	annoyances; worries	*In old times, say the Indian traditions, there was a kind of Manitou or Spirit, who kept about the wildest recesses of the Catskill mountains, and took a mischievous pleasure in wreaking all kind of evils and vexations upon the red men.*	
revisit (verb)	visit again	*He determined to revisit the scene of the last evening's gambol, and if he met with any of the party, to demand his dog and gun.*	"revisit": Origin: Middle French revisiter; earlier Latin revīsitāre. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/revisit#Etymology)
counterpart (noun)	something very like another; a copy	*Rip looked, and beheld a precise counterpart of himself as he went up the mountain; apparently as lazy, and certainly as ragged.*	"counterpart": Origin: an English formation from counter- + part. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/counterpart#Etymology)
obsequious (adjective)	attempting to win favor from influential people by flattery	*Indeed, to the latter circumstance might be owing that meekness of spirit which gained him such universal popularity; for those men are apt to be obsequious and conciliating abroad, who are under the discipline of shrews at home.*	
narrated (verb)	provide commentary for a film, for example	*Knickerbocker by a little German superstition about the Emperor Frederick der Rothbart and the Kypphauser mountain; the subjoined note, however, which had appended to the tale, shows that it is an absolute fact, narrated with his usual fidelity.*	
precipices (noun)	a very steep cliff	*Passing through the ravine, they came to a hollow, like a small amphitheatre, surrounded by perpendicular precipices, over the brinks of which impending trees shot their branches, so that you only caught glimpses of the azure sky, and the bright evening cloud.*	
occurrences (noun)	an event that happens	*The birds were hopping and twittering among the bushes, and the eagle was wheeling aloft, and breasting the pure*	"occurrences": From Latin occurrere "to run to meet," from ob- "toward" + currere "to run." (Online Etymology

		mountain breeze. "Surely," thought Rip, "I have not slept here all night." He recalled the occurrences before he fell asleep.	Dictionary (hand-checked note), https://www.etymonline.com/word/occurrence)
tempers (noun)	natures; dispositions	*Their tempers, doubtless, are rendered pliant and malleable in the fiery furnace of domestic tribulation, and a curtain-lecture is worth all the sermons in the world for teaching the virtues of patience and long-suffering.*	

Discussion questions

1. If you fell asleep for twenty years, what would surprise you most when you woke?
2. Where does setting appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with change and time?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does Rip go into the mountains? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To escape his wife's scolding
2. What game are the strange men playing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Ninepins
3. How long does Rip sleep? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Twenty years
4. What has replaced King George on the inn's sign? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: George Washington
5. Who is the 'Rip Van Winkle' leaning against a tree? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rip's grown son
6. Retell the three most important events of “Rip Van Winkle” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Good-natured, idle Rip Van Winkle wanders into the Catskill Mountains to escape his scolding wife, meets strange men in old Dutch dress playing ninepins, drinks their liquor, and falls asleep. He wakes twenty years later, bearded and stiff. In the village, King George's portrait has become George Washington, his wife is dead, and the Revolution has happened. He settles into old age telling his…

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Rip Van Winkle”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Rip Van Winkle” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: “They are a dismembered branch of the great Appalachian family, and are seen away to the west of the river, swelling up to a noble height, and lording it over the surrounding country.” What does “dismembered” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: dismembered: separated, detached (from the main range).
10. Reread: “Indeed, to the latter circumstance might be owing that meekness of spirit which gained him such universal popularity; for those men are apt to be obsequious and conciliating abroad, who are under the discipline of…” What does “conciliating” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: conciliating: friendly and trying to win good will.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Rip Van Winkle” suggest about waking into a changed nation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: One of the first American short stories to become a national myth.
2. Find one example of setting in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the irony in this story shape what we understand about waking into a changed nation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74): Rip's escape. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “On waking, he found himself on the green knoll whence he had first seen the old man of the glen.”, why might Irving have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Rip Van Winkle”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Good-natured, idle Rip Van Winkle wanders into the Catskill Mountains to escape his scolding wife, meets strange men in old Dutch dress playing ninepins, drinks their liquor, and falls asleep. He wakes twenty years later, bearded and stiff. In the village, King George's portrait has become George…
6. As the opening story, what does “Rip Van Winkle” set up that the rest of Rip Van Winkle will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59): Identity crisis. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70): The sleep. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “If you fell asleep for twenty years, what would surprise you most when you woke?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with change and time? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74): Rip's escape. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1819 in The Sketch Book under the persona 'Geoffrey Crayon' and the fictional historian Diedrich Knickerbocker; Irving adapted a German folktale. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59): Identity crisis. On setting: The Catskills are magical; the village is ordinary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “One of the first American short stories to become a national myth.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70): The sleep. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74): Rip's escape. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Rip Van Winkle” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about waking into a changed nation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59): Identity crisis. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Rip Van Winkle”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70): The sleep. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this story to the American Revolution: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Irving need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74): Rip's escape. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the setting in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59): Identity crisis. On setting: The Catskills are magical; the village is ordinary. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Rip Van Winkle” treats waking into a changed nation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Rip Van Winkle see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70): The sleep. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General

Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final story, does this ending resolve change and time? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74): Rip's escape. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about waking into a changed nation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59): Identity crisis. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Washington Irving about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Useful evidence: “the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70): The sleep. Theme link: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Rip looked, and beheld a precise _____ of himself as he went up the mountain; apparently as lazy, and certainly as ragged.” Word bank: dismembered, conciliating, vexations, counterpart
   Key: counterpart
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70: “the whole _____ years had been to him but as one night”
   Key: twenty
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Knickerbocker by a little German superstition about the Emperor Frederick der Rothbart and the Kypphauser mountain; the subjoined note, however, which had appended to the tale, shows that it is an

absolute fact, _____ with his usual fidelity." Word bank: vexations, conciliating, dismembered, narrated

Key: narrated

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 32: "The whole group reminded Rip of the figures in an old Flemish painting, in the parlor of Dominie Van Schaick, the village parson, and which had been brought over from Holland at the time of the _____." Word bank: whistled, settlement, discussions, begotten

   Key: settlement

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How long does Rip sleep?

   A. Twenty years
   B. Seven years
   C. One night
   D. A hundred years

   Key: A (Twenty years)

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What game are the strange men playing?

   A. Dice
   B. Ninepins
   C. Chess
   D. Cards

   Key: B (Ninepins)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 23: "Rip's sole domestic adherent was his dog Wolf, who was as much henpecked as his master; for Dame Van Winkle regarded them as _____ in idleness, and even looked upon Wolf with an evil eye, as the cause of his master's going so often astray." Word bank: discussions, companions, deceived, approached

   Key: companions

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 37? "He _____ after him and shouted his name, but all in vain; the echoes repeated his whistle and shout, but no dog was to be seen."

   A. settlement
   B. squirrels
   C. sympathized
   D. whistled

   Key: D (whistled)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Rip go into the mountains?

   A. To fight the British
   B. To escape his wife's scolding
   C. To find gold
   D. To hunt a bear

   Key: B (To escape his wife's scolding)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Passing through the ravine, they came to a hollow, like a small amphitheatre, surrounded by perpendicular _____,

over the brinks of which impending trees shot their branches, so that you only caught glimpses of the azure sky, and the bright evening cloud." Word bank: dismembered, vexations, precipices, conciliating
Key: precipices

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "petticoat government" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Rip's escape. The evidence is "petticoat government" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74). This develops change and continuity: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 39 reveal about the character or situation? "The rocks presented a high impenetrable wall, over which the torrent came tumbling in a sheet of feathery foam, and fell into a broad deep basin, black from the shadows of the surrounding forest." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 39) shows the situation turning on change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "impenetrable" and "surrounding" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 12 reveal about the character or situation? "Whenever, therefore, he happened upon a genuine Dutch family, snugly shut up in its low-roofed farm-house, under a spreading sycamore, he looked upon it as a little clasped volume of black-letter, and studied it with the zeal of a bookworm." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 12) shows the situation turning on change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "spreading" and "therefore" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: The sleep. The evidence is "the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70). This develops change and continuity: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "twenty" and "whole" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 24 shapes its tone: "Times grew worse and worse with Rip Van Winkle as years of matrimony rolled on; a tart temper never mellows with age, and a sharp tongue is the only edged tool that grows keener with constant use." Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words "matrimony" and "constant" (paragraph 24) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Identity crisis. The evidence is "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else" (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59). This develops change and continuity: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "somebody" and "myself" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Rip, still free of "petticoat government," wonders "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else," yet he soon settles back exactly as before.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 12: “The following Tale was found among the papers of the late Diedrich Knickerbocker, an old gentleman of New York, who was very curious in the Dutch History of the province and the manners of the _____ from its primitive settlers.” Word bank: personages, character, overpowered, descendants

    Key: descendants

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 19? “He would carry a fowling-piece on his shoulder, for hours together, trudging through woods and swamps, and up hill and down dale, to shoot a few _____ or wild pigeons.”

    A. sympathized

    B. overlook

    C. whistled

    D. squirrels

    Key: D (squirrels)

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Identity crisis. The evidence is “I'm not myself--I'm somebody else” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 59). This develops change and continuity: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 45 shapes its tone: “There was, as usual, a crowd of folk about the door, but none that Rip recollected.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “recollected” (paragraph 45) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 41 shapes its tone: “His mind now misgave him; he began to doubt whether both he and the world around him were not bewitched.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “bewitched” and “whether” (paragraph 41) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 33 to the story's treatment of change and time: “Nothing interrupted the stillness of the scene but the noise of the balls, which, whenever they were rolled, echoed along the mountains like rumbling peals of thunder.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 33) develops change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “interrupted” and “mountains” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He even ventured, when no eye was fixed upon him, to taste the beverage which he found had much of the flavor of…” (paragraph 35), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating change and time as central.

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 28? “From an opening between the trees, he could _____ all the lower country for many a mile of rich woodland.”

    A. personages

    B. descendants

C. overlook

D. incessantly

Key: C (overlook)

24. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What has replaced King George on the inn's sign?

A. George Washington

B. Rip himself

C. A ship

D. A bear

Key: A (George Washington)

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 20 shapes its tone: “In fact, he declared it was of no use to work on his farm; it was the most pestilent little piece of ground in the whole country; everything about it went wrong, in spite of him.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “everything” and “pestilent” (paragraph 20) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 30 to the story's treatment of change and time: “As he was about to descend, he heard a voice from a distance hallooing: ‘Rip Van Winkle!” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 30) develops change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “hallooing” and “distance” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Rip now felt a vague apprehension stealing over him; he looked anxiously in the same direction, and perceived a strange…” (paragraph 30), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating change and time as central.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who is the 'Rip Van Winkle' leaning against a tree?

A. Rip's grown son

B. Rip's grandson

C. A ghost

D. A stranger

Key: A (Rip's grown son)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 56 to the story's treatment of change and time: “Every answer puzzled him too, by treating of such enormous lapses of time, and of matters which he could not understand: war--Congress-Stony-Point;--he had no courage to ask after any more friends, but cried out in despair, ‘Does nobody…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 56) develops change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “understand” and “enormous” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “At this critical moment a fresh, comely woman pressed through the throng to get a peep at the gray-bearded man.” (paragraph 60), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating change and time as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Rip's escape. The evidence is “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74). This develops change and continuity: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words “government” and “petticoat” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Rip, still free of "petticoat government," wonders "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else," yet he soon settles back exactly as before.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how change and continuity develops from the opening of “Rip Van Winkle” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
Sample answer: Near the start, “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74) — Rip's escape. Later, “the whole twenty years had been to him but as one night” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 70) — The sleep. The inn sign changes from King George to General Washington.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 71 to the story's treatment of change and time: “Peter was the most ancient inhabitant of the village, and well versed in all the wonderful events and traditions of the neighborhood.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 71) develops change and time: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “neighborhood” and “traditions” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “To make a long story short, the company broke up, and returned to the more important concerns of the election.” (paragraph 72), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating change and time as central.

32. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Rip Van Winkle”? The village politics after the Revolution are as noisy and empty as before.
A. Metaphor
B. Satire
C. Symbolism
D. Irony
Key: B (Satire)

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74).
Sample answer: Rip, still free of "petticoat government," wonders "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else," yet he soon settles back exactly as before. The evidence is “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74) — Rip's escape. This develops change and continuity: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 9, 17, 3, 18, 7, 2, 5, 12, 13, 19, 11, 15, 20, 21, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	23, 4, 10, 5, 3, 24, 1, 7, 18, 12, 13, 25, 21, 15, 22, 26	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 10, 1, 24, 27, 5, 23, 18, 13, 12, 14, 20, 15, 21, 26, 28	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	18, 9, 27, 1, 7, 8, 13, 19, 12, 15, 20, 25, 21, 28, 29, 30	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 1, 4, 6, 5, 24, 21, 20, 15, 25, 28, 31, 16, 29, 26, 22	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Freshman	6, 18, 9, 1, 3, 13, 21, 32, 15, 25, 20, 26, 22, 29, 28, 31	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	18, 3, 1, 9, 6, 32, 20, 21, 14, 25, 33, 15, 28, 26, 31, 22	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 4

College Junior	8, 2, 1, 9, 6, 5, 25, 20, 21, 14, 16, 31, 28, 26, 30, 22	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Senior	17, 9, 6, 5, 24, 7, 21, 20, 15, 14, 33, 26, 31, 30, 22, 28	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	27, 1, 3, 9, 6, 23, 19, 20, 15, 21, 31, 22, 30, 29, 26, 28	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Rip Van Winkle,” how does Irving show waking into a changed nation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Rip Van Winkle, how does Irving develop the idea of waking into a changed nation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Rip Van Winkle develops the idea of waking into a changed nation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Analyze how the structure of Rip Van Winkle (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of waking into a changed nation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.9): Two readers disagree about what Rip Van Winkle suggests about waking into a changed nation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's setting and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Washington Irving uses setting in Rip Van Winkle to complicate the reader's understanding of waking into a changed nation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Situate Rip Van Winkle within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of waking into a changed nation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Read Rip Van Winkle alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of waking into a changed nation follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Rip Van Winkle and its treatment of waking into a changed nation. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's setting and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads Rip Van Winkle as evidence for a larger claim about waking into a changed nation in Rip Van Winkle. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads Rip Van Winkle as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of waking into a changed nation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Rip Van Winkle.

SAT-style questions

1. *In old times, say the Indian traditions, there was a kind of Manitou or Spirit, who kept about the wildest recesses of the Catskill mountains, and took a mischievous pleasure in wreaking all kind of evils and vexations upon the red men.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “vexations” most nearly mean?

   A. an event that happens

   B. natures; dispositions

   C. a very steep cliff

   D. annoyances; worries

2. *On waking, he found himself on the green knoll whence he had first seen the old man of the glen. He rubbed his eyes--it was a bright sunny morning. The birds were hopping and twittering among the bushes, and the eagle was wheeling aloft, and breasting the pure mountain breeze. "Surely," thought Rip, "I have not slept here all night." He recalled the occurrences before he fell asleep. The strange man with the keg of liquor--the mountain ravine--the wild retreat among the rocks--the woe-begone party at ninepins--the flagon--"Oh! that flagon! that wicked flagon!" thought Rip--"what excuse shall I make to Dame Van Winkle?"*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Rip Van Winkle”?

   A. Racial pride destroying love

   B. Waking into a changed nation

   C. Accepting one's place in nature's cycle

   D. Greed that grasps more than a person needs

SAT key: 1. D (annoyances; worries); 2. B (Waking into a changed nation)

Unit test

Rip Van Winkle: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 34? "His _____ now emptied the contents of the keg into large flagons, and made signs to him to wait upon the company."

   A. incessantly
   B. companion
   C. overpowered
   D. character

   Key: B (companion)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 35: "One taste provoked another; and he reiterated his visits to the flagon so often, that at length his senses were _____, his eyes swam in his head, his head gradually declined, and he fell into a deep sleep." Word bank: personages, begotten, overpowered, squirrels

   Key: overpowered

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 21: "His son Rip, an urchin _____ in his own likeness, promised to inherit the habits, with the old clothes, of his father." Word bank: character, overpowered, begotten, personages

   Key: begotten

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 27: "Here he would sometimes seat himself at the foot of a tree, and share the contents of his wallet with Wolf, with whom he _____ as a fellow-sufferer in persecution." Word bank: descendants, settlement, incessantly, sympathized

   Key: sympathized

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Indeed, to the latter circumstance might be owing that meekness of spirit which gained him such universal popularity; for those men are apt to be _____ and conciliating abroad, who are under the discipline of shrews at home." Word bank: dismembered, obsequious, vexations, conciliating

   Key: obsequious

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 18: “The children of the village, too, would shout with joy whenever he _____.” Word bank: incessantly, begotten, whistled, approached

   Key: approached

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 32? “On a level spot in the centre was a company of odd-looking _____ playing at ninepins.”

   A. overlook

   B. incessantly

   C. personages

   D. discussions

   Key: C (personages)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from paragraph 30: “He thought his fancy must have _____ him, and turned again to descend, when he heard the same cry ring through the still evening air, ‘Rip Van Winkle!” Word bank: settlement, deceived, companions, overlook

   Key: deceived

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 13? “There have been various opinions as to the literary _____ of his work, and, to tell the truth, it is not a whit better than it should be.”

   A. sympathized

   B. settlement

   C. descendants

   D. character

   Key: D (character)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 24? “But it would have been worth any statesman's money to have heard the profound _____ which sometimes took place, when by chance an old newspaper fell into their hands from some passing traveller.”

    A. descendants

    B. sympathized

    C. discussions

    D. settlement

    Key: C (discussions)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 22? “Morning, noon, and night, her tongue was _____ going, and every thing he said or did was sure to produce a torrent of household eloquence.”

    A. incessantly

    B. begotten

    C. approached

    D. companions

    Key: A (incessantly)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 60 reveal about the character or situation? “At this critical moment a fresh, comely woman pressed through the throng to get a

peep at the gray-bearded man." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 60) shows the situation turning on the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "critical" and "through" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 43 reveal about the character or situation? "This desolateness overcame all his connubial fears--he called loudly for his wife and children--the lonely chambers rang for a moment with his voice, and then all again was silence." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 43) shows the situation turning on escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "desolateness" and "connubial" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 22 reveal about the character or situation? "He shrugged his shoulders, shook his head, cast up his eyes, but said nothing." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 22) shows the situation turning on escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "shoulders" and "shrugged" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

15. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from paragraph 30 reveal about the character or situation? "Rip now felt a vague apprehension stealing over him; he looked anxiously in the same direction, and perceived a strange figure slowly toiling up the rocks, and bending under the weight of something he carried on his back." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 30) shows the situation turning on the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The words "apprehension" and "anxiously" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 35 shapes its tone: "He even ventured, when no eye was fixed upon him, to taste the beverage which he found had much of the flavor of excellent Hollands." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "excellent" and "ventured" (paragraph 35) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 28 shapes its tone: "He was after his favorite sport of squirrel-shooting, and the still solitudes had echoed and re-echoed with the reports of his gun." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "solitudes" and "shooting" (paragraph 28) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of escape from responsibility: "Whenever he went dodging about the village, he was surrounded by a troop of them hanging on his skirts, clambering on his back, and playing a thousand tricks on him with impunity; and not a dog would bark at him throughout the neighborhood." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 18) develops escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words "neighborhood" and "throughout" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern

returns in "In fact, he declared it was of no use to work on his farm; it was the most pestilent little piece of ground in the…" (paragraph 20), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating escape from responsibility as central.

19. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. "The children of the village, too, would shout with joy whenever he approached."

    B. "Whenever he went dodging about the village, he was surrounded by a troop of them hanging on his skirts, clambering on his back, and playing…"

    C. "In fact, he declared it was of no use to work on his farm; it was the most pestilent little piece of ground in the whole country;…"

    D. "He would carry a fowling-piece on his shoulder, for hours together, trudging through woods and swamps, and up hill and down dale, to shoot…"

    Key: A ("The children of the village, too, would shout with joy whenever he approached.")

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 40 shapes its tone: "As he approached the village, he met a number of people, but none whom he knew, which somewhat surprised him, for he had thought himself acquainted with every one in the country round." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "approached" and "acquainted" (paragraph 40) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 51 shapes its tone: "There was a silence for a little while, when an old man replied, in a thin, piping voice, 'Nicholas Vedder? why, he is dead and gone these eighteen years!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "eighteen" and "replied" (paragraph 51) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 14 shapes its tone: "The old gentleman died shortly after the publication of his work; and now that he is dead and gone, it cannot do much harm to his memory to say that his time might have been much better employed in weightier labors." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "publication" and "gentleman" (paragraph 14) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 37 to the story's treatment of escape from responsibility: "He now suspected that the grave roysterers of the mountains had put a trick upon him, and, having dosed him with liquor, had robbed him of his gun." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 37) develops escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words "roysterers" and "mountains" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "The rocks presented a high impenetrable wall, over which the torrent came tumbling in a sheet of feathery foam, and…" (paragraph 39), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating escape from responsibility as central.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 32 shapes its tone: “Their visages, too, were peculiar; one had a large head, broad face, and small piggish eyes; the face of another seemed to consist entirely of nose, and was surmounted by a white sugar-loaf hat, set off with a little red cock's tail.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “surmounted” and “entirely” (paragraph 32) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 72 shapes its tone: “To make a long story short, the company broke up, and returned to the more important concerns of the election.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “important” and “election” (paragraph 72) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 41 to the story's treatment of escape from responsibility: “A troop of strange children ran at his heels, hooting after him, and pointing at his gray beard.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 41) develops escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “pointing” and “children” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “His mind now misgave him; he began to doubt whether both he and the world around him were not bewitched.” (paragraph 41), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating escape from responsibility as central.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 68 shapes its tone: “I am your father!’ cried he-‘Young Rip Van Winkle once-old Rip Van Winkle now--Does nobody know poor Rip Van Winkle!” Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words “father” and “nobody” (paragraph 68) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 46 to the story's treatment of the American Revolution: “The appearance of Rip, with his long, grizzled beard, his rusty fowling-piece, his uncouth dress, and the army of women and children at his heels, soon attracted the attention of the tavern politicians.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 46) develops the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “politicians” and “appearance” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “There was a silence for a little while, when an old man replied, in a thin, piping voice, ‘Nicholas Vedder? why, he is…” (paragraph 51), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the American Revolution as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 42 to the story's treatment of the American Revolution: “He found the house gone to decay--the roof had fallen in, the windows shattered, and the doors off the hinges.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 42) develops the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “shattered” and “windows” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “This desolateness overcame all his connubial fears--he called loudly for his wife and children--the lonely chambers…”

(paragraph 43), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the American Revolution as central.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] In the line “They are a dismembered branch of the great Appalachian family, and are seen away to the west of the river, swelling up to a noble height, and lording it over the surrounding country.”, what does “dismembered” most nearly mean?

    A. annoyances; worries

    B. friendly and trying to win good will

    C. visit again

    D. separated, detached (from the main range)

    Key: D (separated, detached (from the main range))

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from paragraph 25 to the story's treatment of the American Revolution: “His adherents, however (for every great man has his adherents), perfectly understood him, and knew how to gather his opinions.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 25) develops the American Revolution: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “understood” and “adherents” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He was after his favorite sport of squirrel-shooting, and the still solitudes had echoed and re-echoed with the reports…” (paragraph 28), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating the American Revolution as central.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] In the line “In old times, say the Indian traditions, there was a kind of Manitou or Spirit, who kept about the wildest recesses of the Catskill mountains, and took a mischievous pleasure in wreaking all kind of evils and vexations…”, what does “vexations” most nearly mean?

    A. annoyances; worries

    B. visit again

    C. separated, detached (from the main range)

    D. friendly and trying to win good will

    Key: A (annoyances; worries)

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Connect this passage from paragraph 75 to the story's treatment of escape from responsibility: “He used to tell his story to every stranger that arrived at Mr. Doolittle's hotel.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 75) develops escape from responsibility: the inn sign changes from King George to General Washington. Its words “stranger” and “arrived” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Whenever, therefore, he happened upon a genuine Dutch family, snugly shut up in its low-roofed farm-house, under a…” (paragraph 12), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating escape from responsibility as central.

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] In the line “He determined to revisit the scene of the last evening's gambol, and if he met with any of the party, to demand his dog and gun.”, what does “revisit” most nearly mean?

    A. friendly and trying to win good will

    B. separated, detached (from the main range)

    C. annoyances; worries

D. visit again

Key: D (visit again)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 11, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	10, 2, 9, 11, 8, 1, 7, 6, 5, 4, 19, 12, 13, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	7, 5, 3, 8, 11, 6, 9, 15, 19, 12, 13, 19, 14, 24, 22, 25, 26, 23	recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 4, 3, 10, 8, 7, 12, 15, 19, 19, 14, 13, 27, 21, 17, 20, 23, 28	recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	6, 7, 2, 11, 9, 13, 19, 12, 14, 15, 19, 27, 16, 21, 20, 18, 28, 29	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 30, 11, 5, 19, 13, 14, 25, 17, 16, 27, 22, 24, 31, 29, 18, 26, 28	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman	30, 5, 6, 12, 19, 13, 15, 24, 16, 25, 22, 20, 17, 29, 23, 31, 18, 26	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	32, 4, 12, 15, 19, 19, 27, 25, 21, 24, 20, 22, 28, 33, 29, 26, 18, 31	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	2, 30, 19, 12, 20, 22, 17, 27, 21, 16, 24, 31, 23, 26, 33, 29, 18, 28	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 7, synthesis 7
College Senior	10, 5, 13, 19, 20, 16, 21, 17, 24, 25, 27, 29, 26, 28, 18, 33, 23, 31	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 7, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	34, 6, 19, 21, 20, 27, 24, 16, 25, 22, 17, 26, 29, 31, 18, 33, 28, 23	recall 2, inference 1, analysis 8, synthesis 7

Final paper

Rip Van Winkle: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Washington Irving develops change and time across Rip Van Winkle. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Rip Van Winkle and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to the American Revolution.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Rip Van Winkle. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Rip Van Winkle finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of escape from responsibility. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: Irving suggests the Revolution changed the surface more than the people. The text makes this visible when it says “petticoat government” (Rip Van Winkle, paragraph 74). Rip, still free of "petticoat government," wonders "I'm not myself--I'm somebody else," yet he soon settles back exactly as before. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Change and time

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rip Van Winkle teaches about change and time. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops change and time in Rip Van Winkle. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops change and time across Rip Van Winkle. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rip Van Winkle (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of change and time. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of change and time in Rip Van Winkle. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in Rip Van Winkle (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of change and time, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rip Van Winkle's treatment of change and time in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on change and time in Rip Van Winkle that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on change and time in Rip Van Winkle. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about change and time in Rip Van Winkle, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on change and time in Rip Van Winkle, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The American Revolution

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rip Van Winkle teaches about the American Revolution. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops the American Revolution in Rip Van Winkle. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops the American Revolution across Rip Van Winkle. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rip Van Winkle (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the American Revolution. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the American Revolution in Rip Van Winkle. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in Rip Van Winkle (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the American Revolution, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rip Van Winkle's treatment of the American Revolution in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the American Revolution in Rip Van Winkle that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the American Revolution in Rip Van Winkle. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the American Revolution in Rip Van Winkle, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the American Revolution in Rip Van Winkle, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Escape from responsibility

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Rip Van Winkle teaches about escape from responsibility. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Washington Irving develops escape from responsibility in Rip Van Winkle. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Washington Irving develops escape from responsibility across Rip Van Winkle. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Rip Van Winkle (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of escape from responsibility. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of escape from responsibility in Rip Van Winkle. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Washington Irving's choices in Rip Van Winkle (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of escape from responsibility, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Rip Van Winkle's treatment of escape from responsibility in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on escape from responsibility in Rip Van Winkle that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on escape from responsibility in Rip Van Winkle. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about escape from responsibility in Rip Van Winkle, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on escape from responsibility in Rip Van Winkle, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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